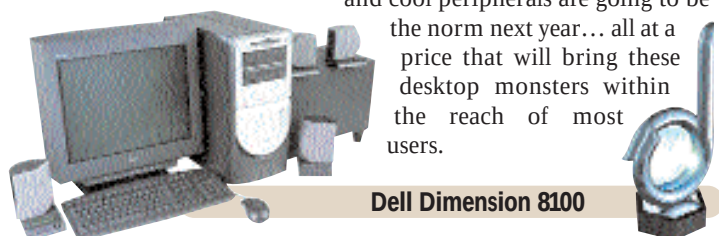


## DESKTOP PCS

Now this is one place where things just don't stand still. Being a unification of a whole gamut of technologies, desktop PCs have seen major transitions in power and functionality over the past year. From faster and more feature-rich processors to blazingly fast graphics sub-systems and seriously powerful speakers, desktop computers have evolved in sheer functionality and processing power. The norm in today's top-of-the-line computers is 17-inch monitors, 64 MB graphics cards, DVD drives and surround sound speaker systems.

With newer processors such as Intel's Northwood and AMD's Athlon XP, there is plenty to look forward to on the processing front. You can expect a similar situation where graphics cards are concerned: more powerful graphics sub-systems are going to appear in desktops. With a very definite drop in the prices of TFTs, the coming year is going to witness more and more PC manufacturers bundling TFT display systems along with their systems. Faster motherboards and memory sub-systems, DVD,

and cool peripherals are going to be the norm next year... all at a price that will bring these desktop monsters within the reach of most users.



Dell Dimension 8100

*Truly a class apart and boasts of a configuration that can give its competition a complex*

When it comes to sheer processing power, in terms of the processor or the graphics sub-systems, there's nothing that can touch the Dell Dimension 8100. With a 1.5 GHz Pentium 4 processor, a GeForce3 graphics accelerator, DVD, and a high-end Turtle Beach multi-channel sound card, the machine is the epitome of power on your desktop. Add to that the excellent build quality and the very thorough documentation and you have a machine that few other brands can touch in terms of power, looks and functionality.

- + Best-of-class system components
  - + Outstanding build quality
- Price:** Rs 98,134

**Contact:** Dell India  
**Phone:** 080-5586110  
**Reviewed in:** October 2001

### Worthy Mentions

#### Amdell Monster PC 1400

- + Very commendable performance in multimedia-heavy applications
- Price:** Rs 65,000  
**Contact:** Intelisys India Ltd  
**Phone:** 022-8527000/8000  
**Fax:** 022-8519723  
**Reviewed in:** October 2001

#### HCL Beanstalk Omega

- + Good performance in image editing applications
  - + Competitively priced
- Price:** Rs 46,999 + taxes  
**Contact:** HCL Infosystems  
**Phone:** 4520977  
**Fax:** 914-555221  
**Reviewed in:** October 2001

**PREVIOUS WINNERS** 2000: The Best Coppermine 770E  
 1999: Siemens Scenic 600 1998: NA

## DIGITAL CAMERAS

As these gadgets become more advanced and sophisticated, they will certainly become a lot more complex, with more technology squeezed inside tiny boxes. A lot of integration has seen the birth of many multipurpose cameras as well, serving as a device for recording video in addition to taking still pictures. Image quality is the single most important characteristic of a digital camera. 6 Megapixel cameras offer the best image quality but also carry a heavy price tag. The demands of professional photography have brought forth cameras that carry high pixel ratings and a truckload of features.

Well into the future, there will be significant advances in digital camera technology. Image sensors will pack a higher density of pixels as well as image enhancing algorithms to filter out noise and visual distortions. But with convergence being the buzzword these days, it shouldn't sound surprising to hear that digital cameras, PDAs, cell phones and digital camcorders will blur into a single device.



Sony DSC-P1

*Pixel-perfect reproduction in an easy-to-use package. Plus the ability to shoot a maximum of 1 minute of video together with voice recording*

This camera, despite its very small form factor, has brilliant optical and imaging features and packs plenty of punch into a small package. It offers features—such as taking integrated filters for black and white and sepia modes, adjusting white balance, etc—coupled with extreme ease of navigation, and is a very good choice for the discerning user who needs portability coupled with performance.

- + Great features
  - + Picks up finer details very well
- Price:** Rs 49,990  
**Contact:** Best International  
**Phone:** 022-2611050

**Fax:** 022-2616886  
**E-mail:** bestint@vsnl.com  
**Reviewed in:** August 2001

### Worthy Mentions

#### Kodak DC- 4800

- + Brilliant optics and very sharp image quality
  - + Clear LCD viewfinder
- Price:** Rs 49,000  
**Contact:** Neoteric Informatique  
**Phone:** 022-4172600  
**Fax:** 022-4185294  
**E-mail:** sales@neoteric-info.com  
**Reviewed in:** August 2001

#### Canon Ixus

- + Plenty of bundled software with rechargeable batteries
  - + Great looking and very light
- Price:** Not available  
**Contact:** Mahatta Camera Corporation  
**Phone:** 022-8504608  
**Fax:** 022-8508065  
**E-mail:** mccbom@vsnl.com  
**Reviewed in:** August 2001

**PREVIOUS WINNERS** 2000: ClickIt! DCE 400 1999: NA 1998: Kodak DC 210